undefined

A variable that hasn't been assigned a value doesn't reference anything and so has the value `undefined`. When you evaluate an undefined value, you get a reference error (as you saw earlier with Pegasus):

```
pegasus
# ReferenceError: pegasus is not defined
```

null

A variable that is defined can have the `null` value. The `null` value is equal to itself:

```
reference = null
reference == null
# true
```

Types

CoffeeScript is dynamically and weakly typed, which means that the `typeof` operator was never going to be particularly useful. Also, the type of `null` is object:

```
typeof null
# 'object'
```

This problem in JavaScript makes `typeof` barely worth the pixels it appears on.

Programmers who normally use a language that's statically typed need to suspend disbelief as they learn how to solve the same problems without types. Techniques for doing so are covered in chapter 7. For now, remember that CoffeeScript is dynamically and weakly typed: